

## *Opportunity Cost Is Opportunity Lost*

I've said before that 79% of millionaires used their company-sponsored retirement plans to reach the millionaire mark, making it the number one vehicle for wealth building. What we also learned is that 75% of millionaires make regular, consistent investing part of their ongoing personal finances. That means these people have chosen to say no to whatever flashy thing screams for their attention on any given day, and they've remained focused on their ongoing march toward financial independence. They, like Herb earlier in this chapter, have chosen to give their money to the future instead of giving it all to the present. That's what adults do; they can choose to say no to impulse for the sake of longer-term goals. Children do the opposite. Children are slaves to their desire, only focusing on the fun they can have *today*. We all have that battle raging within; we each have an adult and a child inside of us, but we can't let the child make our financial decisions. Kids aren't consistent—they're impulsive. When you throw your investing strategy out the window just to buy a new car or choose to spend this month's investing dollars on a new TV instead, you're acting like a child. And if that goes on too long, you'll hit retirement having only what children have: big dreams and empty pockets.